

**On the outside, the Gujral House in South Delhi is imposing** in its scale and sweep. But once you step inside, it reveals its impressionable heart that absorbs the spirit and essence of the people who inhabit it. For years, it was a playground and crucible for the artistic exploits of the late Satish Gujral, a crucial figure in the modern cultural movement after Independence. Conceived and built in 1969 with architect Raj Rewal, the Gujral House was a sculpture that adapted to the changing light, wind, and even time—a veritable shapeshifter. There are bare walls of exposed brick and raw concrete, lending it a canvas-like quality that now serves as a renewed gallery space that was opened to the public in November 2025.

"This idea was, in fact, conceived by my father during his lifetime, and I had promised him that I would do it, besides the fact that I, too, felt like doing it," says the artist's son, the architect Mohit Gujral. Growing up with his father meant having a ringside view of the social and cultural flux the country was undergoing as a fledgling democracy. His art was more abstract in comparison to the "figurative and pretty work" being done by his contemporaries. "He told me that he wanted to build a house with volumes, spaces and surfaces that can teach people how art should be experienced—almost like a mannequin: how art should be dressed, how it should be placed, how it takes light. In that way, people begin to understand the three-dimensionality of art and how to experience it. He felt, therefore, that this house was a living studio," Mohit says.

***WORLD OF ARCHTECTURE*** is on display at the **GUJRAL HOUSE** from Jan. 30; ***SG100*** is on display at **NGMA, Delhi,** till Mar. 31

So, throughout his lifetime, the house changed shape and form as Satish constantly reconfigured it—shaking things up, moving things around, and using each nook differently on different days. "My father never had a gallery represent him, but he knew everyone because of how socially active he was, and he entertained guests in this house all the time. It was a coffeehouse, gallery, studio and a living space all at once," says Mohit, who has carried this lesson into his own practice, advising young architects to make spaces that are malleable enough to accommodate the

ART GALLERY ▸

# NETWORKING, HARAPPAN STYLE

A brand new gallery at Mumbai's **CSMVS OFFERS WORLD HISTORY** from an inclusive and Indian perspective



When one of the country's premier museums announces a new gallery, the culturati take notice. When it's Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (CSMVS) collaborating with 15 other museums, Indian as well as international, to create a 10,000 sq. ft space dedicated to 300 artefacts that position ancient India at the crossroads of global historical exchange, it is time to witness the magic for oneself. *Networks of the Past: A Study Gallery of India and the Ancient World* is geared towards shining a spotlight on India's history within a broader global context in the period between the Harappan civilisation, which was at its peak around 5,000 years ago, and the Gupta eEmpire in the sixth century CE. Dr

**PAST ECHOES** Below left, weights from Mohenjodaro; right, a sculptural relief of 'mother and child' (2nd century CE); below, a bronze hand from Yemen (2nd-3rd century CE)

